

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION

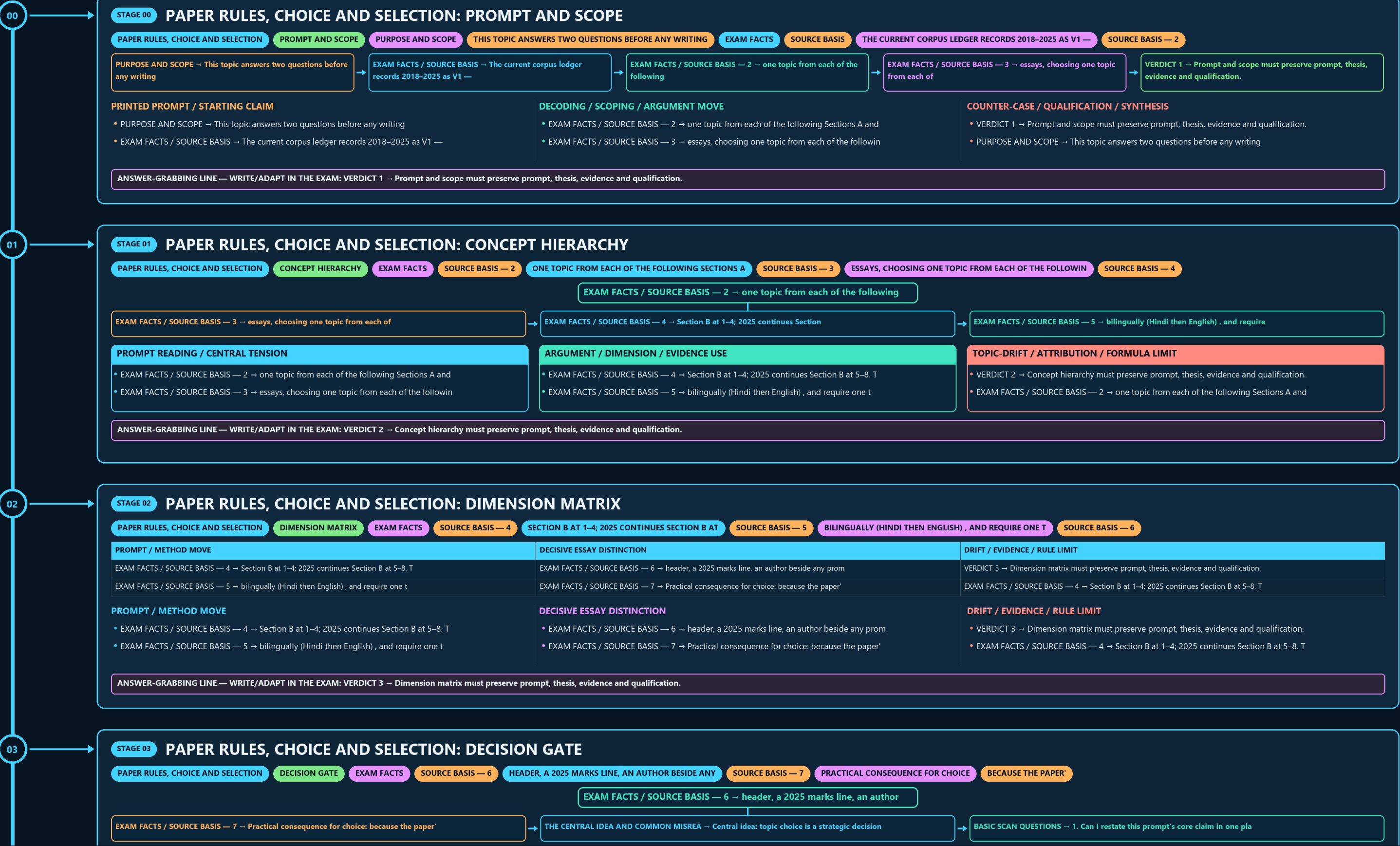
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Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g6 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT 3 → Dimension matrix must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

03

STAGE 03 PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION: DECISION GATE

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION

DECISION GATE

EXAM FACTS

SOURCE BASIS — 6

HEADER, A 2025 MARKS LINE, AN AUTHOR BESIDE ANY

SOURCE BASIS — 7

PRACTICAL CONSEQUENCE FOR CHOICE

BECAUSE THE PAPER'

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 6 → header, a 2025 marks line, an author

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 7 → Practical consequence for choice: because the paper'

THE CENTRAL IDEA AND COMMON MISREA → Central idea: topic choice is a strategic decision

BASIC SCAN QUESTIONS → 1. Can I restate this prompt's core claim in one pla

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION

- EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 6 → header, a 2025 marks line, an author beside any prom
- EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 7 → Practical consequence for choice: because the paper'

ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE

- THE CENTRAL IDEA AND COMMON MISREA → Central idea: topic choice is a strategic decision m
- BASIC SCAN QUESTIONS → 1. Can I restate this prompt's core claim in one pla

TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT

- VERDICT 4 → Decision gate must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.
- EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 6 → header, a 2025 marks line, an author beside any prom

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT 4 → Decision gate must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

04

STAGE 04 PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION: MECHANISM CHAIN

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION

MECHANISM CHAIN

THE CENTRAL IDEA AND COMMON MISREA

CENTRAL IDEA

TOPIC CHOICE IS A STRATEGIC DECISION M

BASIC SCAN QUESTIONS

1. CAN I RESTATE THIS PROMPT'S CORE CLAIM IN

COMPARISON GRID

THE CENTRAL IDEA AND COMMON MISREA → Central idea: topic choice is a strategic decision

BASIC SCAN QUESTIONS → 1. Can I restate this prompt's core claim in one pla

COMPARISON GRID → Use a quick grid — not a full essay plan — to

COMPARISON GRID — 2 → Score honestly; a prompt with weaker fit in two or

VERDICT 5 → Mechanism chain must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

PRINTED PROMPT / STARTING CLAIM

- THE CENTRAL IDEA AND COMMON MISREA → Central idea: topic choice is a strategic decision m
- BASIC SCAN QUESTIONS → 1. Can I restate this prompt's core claim in one pla

DECODING / SCOPING / ARGUMENT MOVE

- COMPARISON GRID → Use a quick grid — not a full essay plan — to compar
- COMPARISON GRID — 2 → Score honestly; a prompt with weaker fit in two or m

COUNTER-CASE / QUALIFICATION / SYNTHESIS

- VERDICT 5 → Mechanism chain must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.
- THE CENTRAL IDEA AND COMMON MISREA → Central idea: topic choice is a strategic decision m

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT 5 → Mechanism chain must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

05

STAGE 05 PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION: COUNTER-VIEW AND SYNTHESIS

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION

COUNTER-VIEW AND SYNTHESIS

COMPARISON GRID

USE A QUICK GRID — NOT A FULL ESSAY

COMPARISON GRID — 2

SCORE HONESTLY; A PROMPT WITH WEAKER FIT IN TWO

INDIA-FIRST ILLUSTRATION STARTERS

BEFORE COMMITTING TO A PROMPT, RECALL — DO NOT

COMPARISON GRID → Use a quick grid — not a full essay plan — to

COMPARISON GRID — 2 → Score honestly; a prompt with weaker fit in two or

INDIA-FIRST ILLUSTRATION STARTERS → Before committing to a prompt, recall — do not inven

THESIS OPTIONS AND SELECTION → For each shortlisted prompt, draft one candidate the

VERDICT 6 → Counter-view and synthesis must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION

- COMPARISON GRID → Use a quick grid — not a full essay plan — to compar
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ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE

- INDIA-FIRST ILLUSTRATION STARTERS → Before committing to a prompt, recall — do not inven
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TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT

- VERDICT 6 → Counter-view and synthesis must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.
- COMPARISON GRID → Use a quick grid — not a full essay plan — to compar

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT 6 → Counter-view and synthesis must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

06

STAGE 06 PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION: CLOSE-OPTION DISTINCTIONS

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION

CLOSE-OPTION DISTINCTIONS

INDIA-FIRST ILLUSTRATION STARTERS

BEFORE COMMITTING TO A PROMPT, RECALL — DO NOT

THESIS OPTIONS AND SELECTION

FOR EACH SHORTLISTED PROMPT, DRAFT ONE CANDIDATE THE

ADVANCED PROPOSITION AND BOUNDARY

TOPIC CHOICE IS BEST MODELLED AS A PORT

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE

INDIA-FIRST ILLUSTRATION STARTERS → Before committing to a prompt, recall — do not inven

THESIS OPTIONS AND SELECTION → For each shortlisted prompt, draft one candidate the

DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION

ADVANCED PROPOSITION AND BOUNDARY → Proposition: topic choice is best modelled as a port

CONCEPT DEFINITION AND TAXONOMY → with visible strain (a warning sign under time press

DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT

VERDICT 7 → Close-option distinctions must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

INDIA-FIRST ILLUSTRATION STARTERS → Before committing to a prompt, recall — do not inven

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE

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06

STAGE 06

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION: CLOSE-OPTION DISTINCTIONS

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION

CLOSE-OPTION DISTINCTIONS

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PROMPT / METHOD MOVE	DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION	DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
INDIA-FIRST ILLUSTRATION STARTERS → Before committing to a prompt, recall — do not inven	ADVANCED PROPOSITION AND BOUNDARY → Proposition: topic choice is best modelled as a port	VERDICT 7 → Close-option distinctions must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.
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PROMPT / METHOD MOVE • INDIA-FIRST ILLUSTRATION STARTERS → Before committing to a prompt, recall — do not inven • THESIS OPTIONS AND SELECTION → For each shortlisted prompt, draft one candidate the	DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION • ADVANCED PROPOSITION AND BOUNDARY → Proposition: topic choice is best modelled as a port • CONCEPT DEFINITION AND TAXONOMY → with visible strain (a warning sign under time press	DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT • VERDICT 7 → Close-option distinctions must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification. • INDIA-FIRST ILLUSTRATION STARTERS → Before committing to a prompt, recall — do not inven

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT 7 → Close-option distinctions must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

07

STAGE 07

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION: EVIDENCE-STATUS LADDER

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION

EVIDENCE-STATUS LADDER

ADVANCED PROPOSITION AND BOUNDARY

TOPIC CHOICE IS BEST MODELLED AS A PORT

CONCEPT DEFINITION AND TAXONOMY

WITH VISIBLE STRAIN (A WARNING SIGN UNDER TIME PRESS

TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO

GUARANTEES WRITING QUALITY IS UNSAFE — INTEREST WITH

ADVANCED PROPOSITION AND BOUNDARY → Proposition: topic choice is best modelled as a port

CONCEPT DEFINITION AND TAXONOMY → with visible strain (a warning sign under time press

TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO → guarantees writing quality is unsafe — interest with

TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO → stacking (fact lists) rather than argument; an unfam

PRINTED PROMPT / STARTING CLAIM

• ADVANCED PROPOSITION AND BOUNDARY → Proposition: topic choice is best modelled as a port

• CONCEPT DEFINITION AND TAXONOMY → with visible strain (a warning sign under time press

DECODING / SCOPING / ARGUMENT MOVE

• TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO → guarantees writing quality is unsafe — interest with

• TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO → stacking (fact lists) rather than argument; an unfam

COUNTER-CASE / QUALIFICATION / SYNTHESIS

• VERDICT 8 → Evidence-status ladder must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

• ADVANCED PROPOSITION AND BOUNDARY → Proposition: topic choice is best modelled as a port

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT 8 → Evidence-status ladder must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

08

STAGE 08

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION: CROSS-SCALE SYSTEM

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION

CROSS-SCALE SYSTEM

TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO

GUARANTEES WRITING QUALITY IS UNSAFE — INTEREST WITH

STACKING (FACT LISTS) RATHER THAN ARGUMENT; AN UNFAM

REVERSE MID-ATTEMPT; THE HIDDEN ASSUMPTION IN "JUST

LEVELS OF ANALYSIS AND TEMPORAL-SP

SELECTION LOGIC SHOULD BE CHECKED AT THREE LEVELS

TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO → stacking (fact lists) rather than argument; an unfam

TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO → guarantees writing quality is unsafe — interest with

TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO → reverse mid-attempt; the hidden assumption in "just

LEVELS OF ANALYSIS AND TEMPORAL-SP → Selection logic should be checked at three levels: (

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION

• TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO → guarantees writing quality is unsafe — interest with

• TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO → stacking (fact lists) rather than argument; an unfam

ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE

• TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO → reverse mid-attempt; the hidden assumption in "just

• LEVELS OF ANALYSIS AND TEMPORAL-SP → Selection logic should be checked at three levels: (

TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT

• VERDICT 9 → Cross-scale system must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

• TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO → guarantees writing quality is unsafe — interest with

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT 9 → Cross-scale system must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

09

STAGE 09

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION: ARGUMENT ARCHITECTURE

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION

ARGUMENT ARCHITECTURE

TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO

REVERSE MID-ATTEMPT; THE HIDDEN ASSUMPTION IN "JUST

LEVELS OF ANALYSIS AND TEMPORAL-SP

SELECTION LOGIC SHOULD BE CHECKED AT THREE LEVELS

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

THIS TOPIC ANSWERS TWO QUESTIONS BEFORE ANY WRITING

LEVELS OF ANALYSIS AND TEMPORAL-SP → Selection logic should be checked at three levels: (

TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO → reverse mid-attempt; the hidden assumption in "just

PURPOSE AND SCOPE → This topic answers two questions before any writing

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS → The current corpus ledger records 2018–2025 as V1 —

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION

• TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO → reverse mid-attempt; the hidden assumption in "just

• LEVELS OF ANALYSIS AND TEMPORAL-SP → Selection logic should be checked at three levels: (

ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE

• PURPOSE AND SCOPE → This topic answers two questions before any writing

• EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS → The current corpus ledger records 2018–2025 as V1 —

TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT

• VERDICT 10 → Argument architecture must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

• TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO → reverse mid-attempt; the hidden assumption in "just

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION • TILE 3/4 • same master rows 5243-8477 of 11098 • continues below

09

STAGE 09

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION: ARGUMENT ARCHITECTURE

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION

ARGUMENT ARCHITECTURE

TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO

REVERSE MID-ATTEMPT; THE HIDDEN ASSUMPTION IN "JUST

LEVELS OF ANALYSIS AND TEMPORAL-SP

SELECTION LOGIC SHOULD BE CHECKED AT THREE LEVELS

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

THIS TOPIC ANSWERS TWO QUESTIONS BEFORE ANY WRITING

LEVELS OF ANALYSIS AND TEMPORAL-SP → Selection logic should be checked at three levels: (

→

PURPOSE AND SCOPE → This topic answers two questions before any writing

→

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS → The current corpus ledger records 2018–2025 as V1 —

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION

TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO → reverse mid-attempt; the hidden assumption in "just

LEVELS OF ANALYSIS AND TEMPORAL-SP → Selection logic should be checked at three levels: (

ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE

PURPOSE AND SCOPE → This topic answers two questions before any writing

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS → The current corpus ledger records 2018–2025 as V1 —

TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT

VERDICT 10 → Argument architecture must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

TENSION PAIRS AND HIDDEN ASSUMPTIO → reverse mid-attempt; the hidden assumption in "just

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT 10 → Argument architecture must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

10

STAGE 10

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION: FAILURE AND REPAIR GATE

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION

FAILURE AND REPAIR GATE

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

THIS TOPIC ANSWERS TWO QUESTIONS BEFORE ANY WRITING

EXAM FACTS

SOURCE BASIS

THE CURRENT CORPUS LEDGER RECORDS 2018–2025 AS V1 —

SOURCE BASIS — 2

PURPOSE AND SCOPE → This topic answers two questions before any writing

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS → The current corpus ledger records 2018–2025 as V1 —

→

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 2 → one topic from each of the following

→

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 3 → essays, choosing one topic from each of

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION

PURPOSE AND SCOPE → This topic answers two questions before any writing

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS → The current corpus ledger records 2018–2025 as V1 —

ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 2 → one topic from each of the following Sections A and

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 3 → essays, choosing one topic from each of the followin

TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT

VERDICT 11 → Failure and repair gate must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

PURPOSE AND SCOPE → This topic answers two questions before any writing

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT 11 → Failure and repair gate must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

11

STAGE 11

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION: COMPLETE ANSWER SPINE

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION

COMPLETE ANSWER SPINE

EXAM FACTS

SOURCE BASIS — 2

ONE TOPIC FROM EACH OF THE FOLLOWING SECTIONS A

SOURCE BASIS — 3

ESSAYS, CHOOSING ONE TOPIC FROM EACH OF THE FOLLOWIN

SOURCE BASIS — 4

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 2 → one topic from each of the following

→

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 3 → essays, choosing one topic from each of

→

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 4 → Section B at 1–4; 2025 continues Section

→

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 5 → bilingually (Hindi then English) , and require

→

VERDICT 12 → Complete answer spine must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 2 → one topic from each of the following Sections A and

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 3 → essays, choosing one topic from each of the followin

ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 4 → Section B at 1–4; 2025 continues Section B at 5–8. T

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 5 → bilingually (Hindi then English) , and require one t

TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT

VERDICT 12 → Complete answer spine must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

EXAM FACTS / SOURCE BASIS — 2 → one topic from each of the following Sections A and

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT 12 → Complete answer spine must preserve prompt, thesis, evidence and qualification.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

APHORISM PROMPTS (MOST OF BOTH YEARS' SECTIONS)

ISSUE-STATEMENT PROMPTS (E.G. 2024-B5 ON SOCIAL MEDIA/FOMO)

HIGH-FIT PROMPT

THESIS EMERGES WITHIN ABOUT A MINUTE, ≥2 REAL

LOW-FIT PROMPT

ANY OF THE ABOVE MISSING, OR ONLY RECOVERABLE

INTEREST VS. TRACTABILITY

OPTIONAL INTERPRETIVE / DIALECTICAL DEPTH

Aphorism prompts (most of both years' Sections): compressed,

Issue-statement prompts (e.g. 2024-B5 on social media/FOMO): more

High-fit prompt: thesis emerges within about a minute, ≥2 real

Low-fit prompt: any of the above missing, or only recoverable

PROMPT, ATTRIBUTION OR OFFICIAL-RULE LIMIT

Interest vs. tractability: the assumption that liking a subject

Familiarity vs. depth: a "familiar" topic invites GS-answer

Speed vs. reversibility: choice happens early and is costly to

NOT: Sunk-cost persistence: continuing with a poorly-fitting prompt

COMPARATIVE ARGUMENT / STRUCTURE NUANCE

NOT: Over-deliberation: spending disproportionate time optimising

NOT: Choosing purely to avoid a weaker Section , ignoring that both

Subject: Essay | Tier: Advanced | GS Paper: Essay (General Studies Paper — Essay, Mains).

Core area: Choice as a portfolio/risk decision

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels

PAPER RULES, CHOICE AND SELECTION • TILE 4/4 • same master rows 7864-11098 of 11098 • end